

Colours

When safety is involved, colours and indicators should comply with IEC 60073.

When colours are used for functional controls or indicators, any colour, including red, is permitted, provided safety is not involved.

Symbols

Refer Table II for symbols used on or near controls. For specific marking of any product, apparatus or appliance, refer relevant standards and specifications.

When symbols are used on or near controls (switches and pushbuttons) to indicate 'on' and 'off' conditions, these should be line | for 'on' and ○ for 'off'.

For pushbutton type switches, symbol ○ should be used. A 'standby' condition should be indicated by symbol ○.

If figures are used to indicate different positions of any control, 'off' position should be indicated by figure '0' (zero). A larger figure should be used to indicate greater output, input, etc.

Isolation of multiple power sources

When there is more than one connection supplying hazardous voltages or hazardous energy to the equipment, a prominent marking—located close to the entry point provided for a service person to gain access to the hazardous parts—should be provided to indicate which disconnection device or devices isolate the equipment completely and which disconnect devices can be used to isolate each section of

the equipment.

Regulating devices

Regulating devices like thermostats, intended to be adjusted during installation or in normal use, should be provided with an indication for the direction of adjustment. Indication by symbol + or — is permitted.

Replaceable batteries

If an equipment is provided with a replaceable battery, and if replacement with an incorrect type could result in an explosion, the following applies:

Caution

Risk of explosion if battery is replaced with an incorrect type.

Dispose of used batteries according to the instructions.

Fuses

For any fuse which may be replaced by an operator, there should be a marking beside the fuse holder, which will enable the operator to identify the correct replacement.

Warning markings

Warning markings should be visible when the equipment is ready for normal use. If the warning applies to a particular part of the equipment, marking △ should be placed on or near it.

As regards the size of warning markings:

1. The symbol should be at least 2.75mm big. Text font should be at least 1.5mm big and coloured in contrast with the background.
2. The symbol or text moulded, stamped or engraved in a material should be at least 2mm big. If not contrasting in colour, these should

have a depth or raised height of at least 0.5 mm.

Durability of marking

Markings should remain clear and legible under conditions of normal use and resist the effects of cleaning agents specified by the manufacturer. Adhesive labels should not become loose or curled at the edge with use.

In a nutshell

Markings are the primary safety requirements and also the basic step towards product certification. A safety certification scheme has been launched by the Standardization, Testing and Quality Certification (STQC) Directorate, Department of Information Technology, Ministry of Communication and Information Technology, at the national level where 'S' mark is issued to products which comply with international standards. Reports for various products are also issued under international safety certification scheme IECEE-CB by STQC Directorate, which is a network of Electronics Regional Test Laboratory (North), New Delhi, Electronics Regional Test Laboratory (West), Mumbai, Electronics Regional Test Laboratory (East), Kolkata, Electronics Regional Test Laboratory (South), Thiruvananthapuram, and Electronics Test and Development Centre, Bengaluru.

Last but not the least, marking is part of safe design. Hence go beyond the minimum and at the end safety saves! ●

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